Even though I understood what she said, I kept a strict watch on the saint as he took the kadah prasad from our bowl. It was so delicious that I didn't want him to keep any of it. But I guess my frown only made him smile more.

Such visits were some of the earliest memories I could remember. Maa and Papaji made the best use of every opportunity to teach us the values that they considered necessary. I had also started to enjoy our stay in Amritsar. With so many places to travel to, so much variety in food to choose from, and the sheer fun-loving spirit and bonhomie among the people, Amritsar became part of me even before I could realize it. No wonder it is called *'Sifti da ghar'*, or the adorable abode. Another memory from Amritsar that was very dear to me was of Tiny Tots School. Dada and I were admitted to the school soon after the winter season, in the beginning of 1979. Two reasons why our parents chose the school, besides its soaring reputation, were that it was in the vicinity of the cantonment and a school-bus service was available. Dada liked the school for its large playground, whereas I liked it for its bright uniform—a dark-blue T-shirt and red shorts. Rita Ma'am, the principal, even let the girls wear colourful ribbons in their plaits. And there was a flower bed on the school's front veranda, which I loved the most. I'd pluck a flower every day to give to Ms Srishti, my favourite teacher, whom I used to affectionately call 'Titli Ma'am'. She'd give me candy in return.

'Dada, get up, or we'll miss the bus,' I would sit on top of Dada and try to wake him up; and he would pull the quilt to his face again. 'Two more minutes,' Dada would murmur, half asleep. It had been two months since we had joined Tiny Tots. I would usually get up on my own, but waking Dada up on time was no easy task.

'Wake up, both of you,' Maa would enter the room with two glasses of warm choco-malt milk. Behind her trailed Chimpu, ready to jump on Dada and lick his face. Every day, Papaji would go for his morning PT while Maa would get us ready for school. She would tie my hair into plaits as I drank my glass of milk. Sometimes I'd get jealous of Dada's low-maintenance crew-cut hairstyle. Sanjay Bhaiya, Papaji's *sahayak*, or aide, helped Maa